

Describing the environment



- 1 Read through the information below and circle the correct word in the brackets.

Ecology (is / are) the study of living things and the way they relate to (there / their) environment or surroundings. The environment (include / includes) things like oxygen, (carbon dioxide / carbondioxide), water, (temparature / temperature), soil, plants, animals and even food.

(Organs / Organisms) can occupy different (enviroments / environments). For example, some organisms (live / lived) on land and others live (on / in) water. No matter (were / where) they live, they all interact (for / with) the living and non-living parts of (their / there) environment.

The living parts (off / of) an environment are called (biotic / bionic) and the non-living parts are called abiotic. These non-living and living parts of an environment make up (a / an) ecosystem. Ecosystems can be (vary / very) large like an ocean or very small like a puddle. Each ecosystem, however, (have / has) a range of living things (which / witch) live (in / on) it.

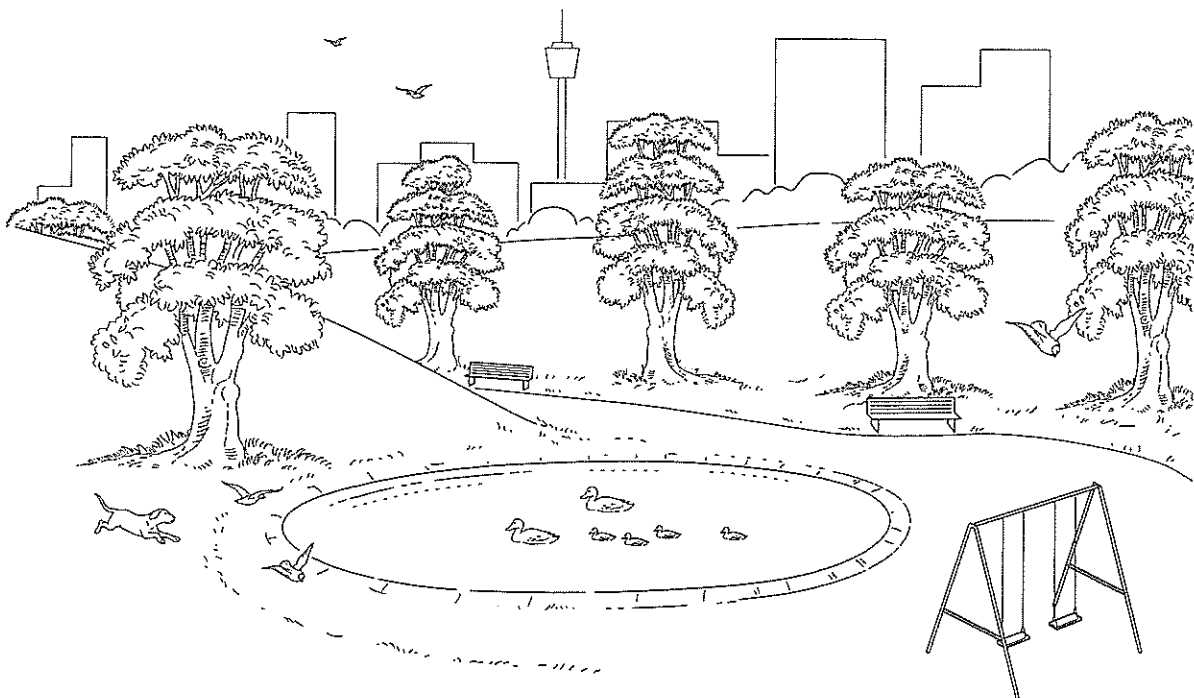
(Within / Without) the ecosystem every living thing has (its/ it's) own special place (to / too) live; this is called its (habitat / habit). The habitat that organisms live (for / in) provides them with all (there / their) needs. A group of organisms (of / off) the same kind, surviving and reproducing amongst each other (in / of) the same habitat, is called a population.

Different groups of organisms that share a habitat make up a (comunity / community). These organisms (need / knead) each other and provide each other (for/ with) shelter and food.

- 2 Complete the table referring to the text above.

- 3 Observe the diagram below. Classify the things in the diagram as biotic or abiotic. Fill in the table provided to record your observations.

Term	Definition
Abiotic	
Biotic	
Community	
Ecology	
Ecosystem	
Environment	
Habitat	
Population	



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Table

- 4 A group of students in Ms Smart's class visited the park shown in the diagram. They took some measurements in three different areas in the park. Their results are shown in the table below.

Aspect	Area 1	Area 2	Area 3
Temperature (°C)	18	26	22
Humidity (%)	–	30	50
Light intensity (1 (min) → 10 (max))	3	10	6
Wind speed (km/h)	0	11	7

- a State which area is:
- i) in the pond _____
 - ii) under the shade of trees _____
 - iii) in the middle of the oval _____
- b Suggest several types of organisms you would expect to see in these three areas.

i) Area 1

ii) Area 2

iii) Area 3

- 5 Describe the specific biotic and abiotic features from one of the three areas.

- 6 List what other abiotic things could be measured in the pond ecosystem and suggest possible measurements.
